

[Your Full Name]
[Your Street Address]
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Goldman Sachs International
Plumtree Court
25 Shoe Lane
London EC4A 4AU
United Kingdom

[DD MMM 2026]

Dear Sir/Madam,

¶1 — THE HOOK. Sentence one lands your genuine connection (the insight day) before anything else. No “I am writing to apply for...”. Strongest real fact first, because the reader skims.

My introduction to Goldman Sachs came not through a job posting, but through [the ____ insight day in ____ 2025/26], where [the one specific thing that genuinely struck you — a person, a moment, an idea]. [One sentence framing what that day changed or confirmed about how you think about a career here.]

¶2 — MIRROR GOLDMAN'S DNA, DON'T FLATTER IT. Pick ONE real trait the insight day surfaced (collaboration / client-first commercial instinct / rigour) and show you already work that way — evidence, not adjectives. Never quote a “value” cold.

[The trait that struck you] was not, in fact, new to me. [Short piece of lived evidence from your own experience that shows you already think/operate this way — a specific moment, not “I am a strong team player”].

¶3 — THE LIKE/DISLIKE ENGINE (Sam's core mechanic). Liked X of experience A (shared with GS) → was missing Y (absent at GS) → therefore Goldman is the synthesis. Keep it firm-level, not one desk — this letter serves multiple divisions.

[Experience A] drew me to [the thing you liked — analysis / markets / building something], but [the thing it lacked]. [Experience B] gave me [that missing thing] and confirmed that what I really want is [the intersection]. Goldman sits precisely where those threads meet — [the analytical + commercial + collaborative blend, phrased so it fits IB, Global Banking & Markets, and Asset & Wealth Management alike].

¶4 — NAMED CONVERSATION + IMPLICIT PROOF OF UNDERSTANDING. The single highest-value line. Name a real person you spoke to at the insight day, then say something about the work only someone who actually spoke to them would know.

I spoke with [Name] ([their role], Goldman Sachs), who [reinforced / reframed] my impression of [the firm / the division]: [a specific, non-obvious observation about how the work actually happens — the kind of detail that proves you were paying attention, not reciting the website].

¶5 + CLOSE — warm, confident, no grovelling, no restating the CV.

[Why Goldman specifically is where you want to begin — one genuine sentence.] I would value the opportunity to contribute to the firm, and I am grateful for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

[Your Full Name]

Template built on Sam Leong's Structure-B ("story") format. Replace every *red italic* placeholder. Formatting rules baked in: your address top-right, Goldman top-left, "Dear Sir/Madam" pairs with "Yours faithfully", one page, no colour in the final version, zero typos. Delete the gold guide-boxes before submitting — they're here only to show you what each paragraph is doing. For Goldman's ~300-word per-division motivation boxes, use ¶1, ¶3 and ¶4 as the spine and re-point the last "why this team" line per division.